

Focus & Productivity Mastery

Deep Work in a Distracted World

The Attention Crisis

The average person:

- Checks phone 150+ times/day
- Gets interrupted every 3 minutes
- Takes 23 minutes to refocus after interruption
- Spends 4+ hours on social media

The cost? Your most valuable asset: FOCUS.

Elite performers protect their attention like their bank account.

Deep Work Defined

Deep Work: Professional activities performed in a state of distraction-free concentration that push your cognitive capabilities to their limit.

Characteristics:

- Uninterrupted focus
- Cognitively demanding
- Creates value
- Difficult to replicate

Examples:

- Strategic planning
- Writing
- Complex problem-solving
- Learning new skills

Goal: 3-4 hours of deep work daily

The Deep Work Protocol

Setup:

- 90-120 minute blocks
- Single task only
- Phone off (not silent, OFF)
- Email closed
- Door closed
- Headphones (if needed)
- Water nearby

Before Starting:

- Clear desk
- Define outcome
- Gather materials
- Use bathroom
- Set timer

During:

- No checking phone
- No email
- No social media
- No interruptions
- Stay on task

After:

- 15-minute break
- Move, hydrate, breathe
- Review progress
- Plan next block

The Pomodoro Technique

For tasks requiring less intensity:

1. Set timer for 25 minutes
2. Work on single task
3. Take 5-minute break
4. Repeat 4 times
5. Take 15-30 minute break

Best for:

- Email processing
- Admin tasks
- Learning
- Routine work

Not for:

- Deep creative work
- Complex problem-solving
- Flow-state activities

Eliminating Distractions

Digital:

- Phone on airplane mode
- Email closed (check 2-3x daily)
- Social media blocked
- Notifications OFF (all of them)
- Browser extensions (Freedom, Cold Turkey)

Physical:

- Clean desk
- Closed door
- Headphones
- Do Not Disturb sign
- Separate workspace

Mental:

- Brain dump before starting
- Clear outcome defined
- Capture system for ideas
- Single-tasking only

The Focus Stack

Morning (Peak Focus):

- 2 hours deep work
- Most important task
- No meetings

- No interruptions

Midday:

- Meetings
- Collaboration
- Admin tasks

Afternoon:

- 1-2 hours deep work
- Secondary priorities
- Learning

Evening:

- Planning tomorrow
- Light tasks
- Recovery

Measuring Focus

Weekly Review:

- Deep work hours (goal: 15-20)
- Phone pickups (goal: <50/day)
- Email checks (goal: 2-3/day)
- Social media time (goal: <30 min/day)
- Interruptions (goal: <5/day)
- Tasks completed (goal: top 3 daily)

If focus is low:

- Reduce phone access
- Block distracting sites
- Increase deep work blocks
- Improve sleep
- Reduce stress